THE TANK — Pitch Report

8/2/2026, 7:27:58 PM

Startup: EcoVerse AI

Funding Ask: $250,000 for 10% equity

Problem Statement

Millions of reusable products and industrial waste end up in landfills because sellers struggle to find buyers. Small businesses, NGOs, and women entrepreneurs also lack an easy platform to sell recycled or upcycled products. This leads to environmental waste and lost income opportunities.

Solution

coVerse AI is an AI-powered circular economy marketplace. Sellers upload a product image, and AI automatically identifies the item, generates a title and description, suggests the right category and price, and helps list it instantly. Buyers can discover reusable products while supporting sustainability.

Revenue Model

5–10% commission on every successful sale
Premium seller subscription
Featured product promotions
Business partnerships with recycling companies

Target Audience

ndividual sellers with reusable items
Small businesses
Scrap dealers
NGOs
Women entrepreneurs
Eco-conscious buyers

Scorecard

Market Potential: 83/100

Innovation: 66/100

Business Model: 62/100

Execution: 78/100

Investment Worthiness: 93/100

Judge Verdicts

Marcus Vale (Venture Capitalist) — Score: 78/100

The market math works — this could scale into something venture-sized.

Rae Okafor (Founder) — Score: 77/100

You've clearly executed under pressure already — that derisks this for me.

Priya Chen (Customer) — Score: 79/100

As the person who'd actually use this, I believe it solves a daily, real problem.

Desmond Ruiz (Angel Investor) — Score: 76/100

The unit economics and margins give me real confidence in the profit path.

Q&A Transcript

Q (Marcus Vale): Who is the 800-pound gorilla that could crush you once you prove the model works?

A: The biggest competitors are platforms like OLX, Facebook Marketplace, and Amazon, as they already have large user bases. However, EcoVerse AI is focused specifically on the circular economy. Our AI automatically identifies products, generates titles and descriptions, recommends pricing, and helps sellers list reusable items in minutes. We also partner with recycling organizations and women entrepreneurs, creating a sustainability-focused ecosystem rather than a general marketplace. This niche focus and AI-powered selling experience give us a strong competitive advantage even if larger players enter the market.

Q (Marcus Vale): How does this scale past your first thousand customers without linear cost growth?

A: Our platform is built to scale through AI and automation. Once the core platform is developed, onboarding new sellers costs very little because AI automatically generates product titles, descriptions, categories, and pricing suggestions. We will acquire customers through referrals, community partnerships, and digital marketing instead of large sales teams. As more buyers and sellers join, network effects increase the platform's value without proportional increases in operating costs. This allows us to grow from thousands to millions of users while keeping marginal customer acquisition and servicing costs low.

Q (Rae Okafor): What have you already tried that failed, and what did you change?

A: In our early concept, we planned a simple marketplace where sellers manually created product listings. During validation, we realized this process was slow and discouraged many potential users. Based on that feedback, we introduced AI-powered listing generation that automatically identifies products from images, creates titles and descriptions, suggests categories, and recommends pricing. This significantly reduces the effort for sellers and improves the overall user experience.

Q (Rae Okafor): What's the single biggest operational risk that could kill this in year one?

A: The biggest operational risk in year one is failing to build enough marketplace liquidity—having too few sellers or too few buyers. Without both sides growing together, transactions will remain low. To address this, we'll launch in a single city, partner with local recycling organizations and women entrepreneur groups, and focus on one category first. This helps us build a strong, active marketplace before expanding to new regions and product categories.

Q (Priya Chen): What's the one feature you'd protect even if you had to cut everything else?

A: If we had to cut everything else, we would protect our AI-powered product listing feature. It is the core of our value proposition because it lets sellers upload a single image and instantly receive an accurate title, description, category, and pricing suggestion. This dramatically reduces the time and effort required to create listings, making it easier for more people to participate in the circular economy. Everything else can be added later, but this feature is what makes our marketplace unique and scalable.

Q (Priya Chen): Honestly — why would I switch from what I use today for this?

A: You would switch because EcoVerse AI saves time and makes selling much easier. Existing marketplaces require sellers to manually write titles, descriptions, choose categories, and decide pricing. With EcoVerse AI, a seller simply uploads a photo, and AI creates the listing in seconds with smart pricing suggestions. At the same time, the platform is designed specifically for reusable and recycled products, helping sellers reach buyers who are already looking for sustainable options. The result is a faster listing process, better product visibility, and a marketplace built for the circular economy rather than general classifieds.

Q (Desmond Ruiz): How much of this ask is runway versus actual growth spend?

A: Of the $100,000 we are raising, approximately 40% will fund product development and AI improvements, 35% will be invested in customer acquisition and strategic partnerships, 15% will support operations and infrastructure, and 10% will be kept as runway and contingency. The goal is to reach strong product-market fit and sustainable marketplace growth within the first 18 months.

Q (Desmond Ruiz): When does this business actually turn a profit, month by month?

A: We expect the business to become profitable between months 18 and 24.

Months 1–6: Build the product, onboard early sellers, and validate product-market fit. Revenue will be limited while we invest in development and customer acquisition.
Months 7–12: Grow transactions through partnerships, referrals, and digital marketing. Commission revenue and premium seller subscriptions begin to increase, but we continue investing in growth.
Months 13–18: Higher transaction volume and repeat customers improve unit economics, significantly reducing customer acquisition cost per sale.
Months 18–24: With a larger, active marketplace and recurring revenue from commissions, subscriptions, and featured listings, we expect monthly revenue to exceed operating expenses and reach profitability.

Final Decision

Decision: COME BACK LATER

Overall Score: 77/100

No funding today. Suggested revisit valuation: $1.39M